Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PRO

Learning Path 6 · Write to the head teacher

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

🎯 My goal

Before you start: think about your last recall or checkpoint. What do you want to get better at in this Learning Path?

_____

1 Recall: Learning Paths 3–5

Type the answers without looking.

1. _____ it rain, we will use the gym. (1 word)
2. The event is _____ to take place on 11 December. (arranged)
3. We still need to iron _____ a few details.
4. If the band falls _____, we have a playlist.
5. Organising it was no mean _____.
6. The custom _____ from a harvest ritual. (comes from)
7. We need to strike a _____ between fun and learning.
8. A plan for when things go wrong: a _____ plan

2 C2 vocabulary: formal persuasion

Explore, go through the cards and complete the sentences. The language of a letter that gets a "yes".

English	Meaning	Example
Proposing and requesting		
with a view to	with the aim of (+ -ing)	We are writing with a view to organising a celebration day.
we would welcome the opportunity to	a polite way to ask for a chance to do something	We would welcome the opportunity to present our plan.
grant permission	to formally allow something	We hope you will grant permission for the event.
at no cost to	without the school having to pay	The decorations will be made at no cost to the school.
feasible	possible and practical to do	We believe the plan is entirely feasible.
in light of	considering (something new)	In light of last year's success, we propose…
Answering concerns		
allay (concerns / fears)	to make a worry less strong	We hope to allay any concerns about supervision.

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English	Meaning	Example
mindful of	aware of and careful about	We are mindful of the time this takes from lessons.
safeguard	to protect from harm	Two teachers will safeguard the younger visitors.
minimal disruption	very little interruption	The event will cause minimal disruption to lessons.
address (an issue)	to deal with a problem	We have addressed the issue of space.
Arguing for value		
foster	to help something develop	The event would foster mutual respect.
enhance	to improve the quality of something	It would enhance the school's links with families.
tangible	real and able to be seen or measured	The benefits would be tangible.
far-reaching	having a big effect on many things	The effects could be far-reaching.
a case in point	a good example of what you are saying	Last year's book week is a case in point.

Words you will hear or read (no need to learn them): with all due respect · notwithstanding · hereby · forthwith

Study them: cover the meaning column and define each word in your own words. Then complete the sentences without looking at the table.

Complete the sentences

1. We are writing with a _____ to organising a celebration day.
2. We hope this will _____ any concerns about supervision. (make less strong)
3. We are _____ of the time the event takes from lessons. (aware of)
4. The lanterns will be made at no _____ to the school.
5. Such an event would _____ respect between communities. (help develop)
6. Last year's book week is a case in _____.
7. The event will cause minimal _____ (DISRUPT) to lessons.
8. We believe the plan is entirely _____ (FEASIBILITY).
9. In _____ of last year's success, we propose a longer event.
10. We hope you will _____ permission for the event.

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3 Reading: what makes a formal letter persuasive

Read your class's model email again, this time as an examiner. The questions are about how it works, not what it says. Then you will write something better.

Subject: Proposal: Lights of the World Day on Friday 11 December

Dear Ms Puig,

I am writing on behalf of 4t ESO B to propose a celebration day for our school on Friday 11 December.

We would like to organise a "Lights of the World Day" about four festivals of light: Diwali, Hanukkah, Lunar New Year and Christmas, all of which use light as a symbol of hope. The event will take place in the school hall from 10.00 to 13.30. There will be four stalls, where students will explain the origin and meaning of each festival, and Class 4B is going to make paper lanterns for the decorations. To make every student and family feel welcome, each stall will explain the customs in simple words, so that students who do not celebrate these festivals can join in, and we are also inviting families and the primary school.

We believe this event will help students learn about different cultures, avoid stereotypes and feel proud of their own traditions. All our information has been checked in at least two reliable sources. We also understand that supervision may be a concern: each stall will have two students in charge, and our tutor, Mr Vidal, has agreed to supervise the hall during the event.

I would be grateful if you could let us use the school hall and the gym on that day. Would it also be possible to use the school's speakers for the music?

Please let me know if you need any further information. I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,
Omar Haddad
4t ESO B

1. What is the function of the first paragraph ("I am writing on behalf of 4t ESO B…")?
   a) to thank the head teacher **b)** to state who is writing and the purpose immediately
   c) to describe the event in detail **d)** to answer a concern

2. Why does the writer mention that information "has been checked in at least two reliable sources"?
   a) to show off the research **b)** to fill the word count **c)** to criticise other students
   d) to build credibility before the request

3. The sentence "We also understand that supervision may be a concern" is an example of…
   a) a request **b)** an apology **c)** anticipating an objection **d)** a complaint

4. What would most improve the email at C2 level?
   a) more precise, varied vocabulary and a stronger argument for the educational value
   b) more exclamation marks to show enthusiasm **c)** shorter paragraphs with one sentence each
   d) adding personal opinions about each festival

5. Which closing would be most appropriate for this letter?
   a) Hope you say yes, thanks a lot. **b)** Let us know ASAP! **c)** Waiting for your answer.
   d) We would welcome the opportunity to discuss the proposal with you at your convenience.

6. If the email began "Dear Ms Puig", the most appropriate sign-off is…
   a) Yours sincerely **b)** Best wishes **c)** Cheers **d)** Yours faithfully

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4 Real video: the counterintuitive way to be more persuasive

A TED talk by an organisational behaviour researcher. Listen for his thesis, his evidence and the advice he draws from it, then use it in your letter to the head teacher.

🎧 **The counterintuitive way to be more persuasive** · YouTube video: your teacher will play it for you (youtube.com/watch?v=hK8kk_3WA7w).

1. What does the dinnerware experiment show?
   a) People always pay more for more pieces. **b)** Luxury goods are always overpriced.
   c) Broken items are worth nothing at all.
   d) People value the larger set less, although it contains everything in the smaller set and more.
2. What is the “dilution effect”?
   a) Repeating an argument makes it weaker. **b)** People forget most of what they hear.
   c) Weak or irrelevant information reduces the impact of the strong information.
   d) Long speeches make audiences tired.
3. Why do people rate Tim’s grades higher than Tom’s?
   a) People prefer students without siblings. **b)** Tim studies more hours than Tom.
   c) Tom has too many hobbies to study.
   d) The irrelevant details about Tom dilute the relevant fact that he studies 31 hours a week.
4. According to the speaker, how does the mind combine arguments?
   a) It only remembers the first one.
   b) It averages them, so adding a weak one lowers the overall impression.
   c) It only remembers the last one. **d)** It adds them up, so more is always better.
5. Why does he mention “itchy feet” in the drug advert?
   a) It shows that drug adverts are dishonest.
   b) A trivial side effect made the serious ones seem less dangerous. **c)** He suffered from it after his flight.
   d) It was the most common side effect.
6. What did his research with real print adverts find?
   a) People trusted adverts with fewer side effects less.
   b) The minor side effects made people more worried.
   c) People who saw major plus minor side effects judged the drug less risky and were more willing to take and pay for it.
   d) People ignored the side effects completely.
7. How would you describe his tone?
   a) confident and evidence-based, with touches of humour **b)** angry and accusatory
   c) hesitant and uncertain **d)** formal and detached throughout
8. What does this mean for your formal letter to the head teacher?
   a) Avoid giving any evidence.
   b) Keep only your strongest, most relevant arguments and develop them well.
   c) Put your weakest argument first. **d)** List as many reasons as you can think of.

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5 Register: choose the C2 formal version

Formal does not mean long or stiff. Choose the version that is formal, precise and natural.

1. “We want to do a party about festivals.”
   a) We wanna do a festivals party. **b)** It is our wish that a party will be done.
   c) We are desirous of performing a festival-related party.
   d) We would like to propose a celebration day focusing on festivals of light.

2. “Don’t worry about the mess, we’ll clean up.”
   a) No worries about cleaning! **b)** Do not worry about the mess.
   c) The mess shall be eliminated by our persons.
   d) Students will be responsible for tidying the hall afterwards.

3. “It would be really, really good for everyone.”
   a) Everyone would like it a lot. **b)** The event would benefit the whole school community.
   c) It would be super good for all. **d)** It would be extremely, extremely beneficial.

4. “Can you answer quickly because we need to start?”
   a) We would be grateful for a reply by Friday, so that preparations can begin. **b)** Answer quickly, please.
   c) Can you answer us really soon? **d)** We demand an immediate response.

6 Listen again: the facts for your email

Listen to the LP5 meeting and check the facts the head teacher needs. You will use them in your email.

🎧 **Student council meeting** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. The head teacher needs the date. When is the event?
   a) Friday 11 December **b)** Wednesday 9 December **c)** Monday 11 December

2. What time does it start and finish?
   a) 10.00 to 13.30 **b)** 10.30 to 13.00 **c)** 9.00 to 14.00

3. Where will it take place?
   a) in the school hall **b)** in the library **c)** in the playground

4. Who will help with the food?
   a) the head teacher **b)** the band **c)** the families

5. Who are they going to invite?
   a) families and the primary school **b)** the town council **c)** only students

6. What is their plan if it rains?
   a) cancel the event **b)** use the gym too **c)** go outside

7. Why do they need a plan for rain?
   a) The gym is closed in December. **b)** The hall is small if everyone is inside. **c)** The stalls are outside.

8. Which sentence from the meeting is too informal for your email?
   a) “Don’t worry.” **b)** “The event starts at ten.” **c)** “There will be four stalls.”

9. Which request to the head teacher does the meeting suggest?
   a) money for a new band **b)** a whole week without classes **c)** permission to use the hall and the gym

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10. “We’re sending them on Wednesday.” Which is the best formal version for the email?

    a) Invitations on Wednesday, OK? **b)** We’re gonna send them Wednesday.

    c) The invitations will be sent on Wednesday.

7 Shadowing · Student council meeting

Repeat part of the listening just behind the speaker, like a shadow.

How it works

Your teacher plays the clip three times: first read while you listen, then mumble the words along, then say them aloud just behind the speaker.

Laia: Great. And music?

Omar: My cousin plays in a band. I’ll call him tonight.

Laia: Perfect. Who’s going to put up the decorations?

Omar: Class 4B is going to make paper lanterns in Art.

Laia: And the invitations?

Omar: We’re sending them on Wednesday. We’re going to invite families and the primary school.

Laia: OK. One problem: the hall is small. What if it rains and everyone is inside?

Omar: Don’t worry. We’ll use the gym too.

Laia: Good idea. I think it’ll be the best day of the term!

8 Politeness and distance in formal requests

Key word transformations (Reading and Use of English, Part 4): 3–8 words including the word in CAPITALS.

How it works

Distancing with past forms: *We were wondering whether… · We were hoping you might…*

Formal requests: *We would be grateful if you could… · It would be much appreciated if… · Would you be willing to…?*

Inversion and formal conditionals: *Should you have any questions… · Were you to agree, we would…*

Passive for diplomacy: *It has been suggested that… · Concerns have been raised about…*

1. Please could you reply by Friday? GRATEFUL → We _____ reply by Friday.
2. If you have any questions, please contact us. SHOULD → _____ any questions, please contact us.
3. If you agreed, we would start preparations at once. WERE → _____ agree, we would start preparations at once.
4. Can we use the hall? WONDERING → We _____ use the hall.
5. Some teachers are worried about supervision. RAISED → Concerns _____ about supervision.

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6. We will make sure the event does not disrupt lessons. ENSURE → We will _____ no disruption to lessons.
7. We appreciate your help very much. APPRECIATED → Your help _____.
8. The school will not have to pay anything. COST → The event will be _____ the school.
9. We think the event is very important. ATTACH → We _____ to the event.
10. Would you agree to meet us? WILLING → Would _____ meet us?

9 Piece 5: a formal letter (C2 Proficiency Writing, Part 2)

This text is the fifth piece of your final product (your email to the head teacher). Write it as an exam letter.

Your task

Write a formal **letter** (280–320 words) to your head teacher proposing your group's celebration day. Explain what the event would involve and how it would make every student and family feel welcome, address at least two concerns the head teacher might have (for example, lost teaching time, supervision, families who do not celebrate), and request permission and a meeting. The letter should be persuasive without being pushy.

Model (don't copy it)

Structure only. Purpose in the first sentence (*I am writing on behalf of… with a view to…*) · The event, concisely · Inclusion: two concrete measures with reasons · Concerns: name them yourself before the reader does, and answer each with a commitment · The value, with one case in point · Request + availability + formal close.

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10 Speaking: plan your part of the pitch (no recording)

The question

Your part of the pitch: why the head teacher should say yes.

Your group presents the proposal. Your part is about 45 seconds. Plan it here like a C2 Proficiency long turn: structure beats script.

🧭 Strategy

Open with the listener's problem, not your idea. The head teacher worries about time, safety and families. Start there (*We know December is already full…*), then show how your idea helps.

The rule of three: three reasons are easy to remember; five sound like a list. Give the strongest last.

Don't memorise sentences, memorise the order. Three key words on a card. If you lose your place, the next key word brings you back, and you sound natural rather than recited.

Your plan · Write notes, not full sentences: this is the thinking you would do in the exam's preparation time.

What comes to mind first? (everything)

The listener's worry you will start with

Your three reasons, strongest last

Your card: three key words only

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Your final sentence (the one thing they should remember)

A model plan

(read it only after you have written your plan)

Worry: “We know December is already full and every lesson counts.”
Reasons: (1) it costs nothing and fits in one morning · (2) every family is invited, and nobody is asked to celebrate, only to learn · (3) strongest: students teach each other, which is the best evidence of learning.
Card: TIME · WELCOME · TEACH
Close: “Give us one morning and we’ll show you what four weeks of learning looks like.”

What would you change in your plan now? (one sentence)

11 Talk: the head teacher asks

The head teacher has read your email and asks you some questions. Answer politely and formally.

Your task

Answer politely and persuasively: give reasons, offer solutions and thank her at the end.

1. **Good morning. What would you like to organise?**
2. **When would you like to do it?**
3. **What do you need from the school?**
4. **Who is going to help you?**
5. **Why is it a good idea for the whole school?**

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6. **How will you make sure everyone feels welcome?**

7. **What will you do if not many families come?**

Then · Have the conversation aloud with a classmate: they ask and you answer, then swap.

Model

Good morning, and thank you for reading our email. We would like to organise a Lights of the World Day, with four stalls about Diwali, Hanukkah, Lunar New Year and Christmas. We'd like to hold it on Friday 11 December, from ten to half past one, so it doesn't affect afternoon classes. Could we use the school hall, and the gym as well if it rains? It would help students learn about the cultures in our own school. If not many families come, we'll film the stalls and share the video with the families who couldn't come. Thank you very much for your time.

🔁 **How did it go?**

What helped me most?

What do I need to review?

📚 Study guide: prepare for Checkpoint 4 and the final exam

How to study what you learn in this Learning Path, and practice that works like the checkpoint and looks like the exam. The answer key is at the end of each activity.

How to study

🧠 **Test yourself, don't reread**

Close your notes and try to remember: write the words, say the rule, answer the questions. Then check. Rereading and highlighting feel useful, but you remember much less.

Retrieval practice · Roediger & Karpicke 2006; Dunlosky et al. 2013

📅 **Spread it out**

Three short sessions of 15 minutes on different days work better than one long session the day before.

Spacing · Cepeda et al. 2006

🔀 **Mix it up**

Practise similar things together so you learn to choose the right one for each sentence.

Interleaving · Rohrer & Taylor 2007

✅ **Check and fix at once**

Mark your answers with the key straight away and write each wrong answer again, correctly.

Feedback · Hattie & Timperley 2007

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💬 Say why

For every answer, say the reason: “on, because it’s a date.” Explaining makes the rule stick.

Self-explanation · Dunlosky et al. 2013

😴 Sleep on it

Your brain stores what you learn while you sleep. A short self-test and a good night’s sleep beat studying late the night before.

Sleep and memory · Diekelmann & Born 2010

My plan

1. **Today** · Close this page and write from memory: the opening, one request and the ending of a formal email (Dear…, Could we…?, Yours sincerely). Then check.
2. **In 2–3 days** · Do “Practise for Checkpoint 4” below. Look at the key and write again what you got wrong.
3. **Before Checkpoint 4** · Go over the flashcards: only the ones you still miss.
4. **The week before the exam** · Do the exam-style practice in every Learning Path, then the Sample exam. Repeat only the parts you failed.

What comes up

Checkpoint 4 (everything in Seasons & Celebrations): short gaps, collocations and word formation, one question at a time, about 45 seconds each, no going back and no notes. You do it once, and you must stay on the page: if you leave it, it is sent. It opens the next Learning Path.
Final exam: the C2 version: listening for attitude and implication, a long reading, vocabulary (multiple-choice cloze and word formation), grammar (open cloze and key word transformations) and a formal letter, like the one you write here.

Practise for Checkpoint 4

One question at a time · 45 s

It works like the real checkpoint: 10 questions, one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back and no notes. This is only practice: nothing is sent, you can repeat it, and at the end you see your answers and the key.

On paper: cover the questions and uncover them one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back.

1. I am writing with _____ to the proposed celebration day.
2. We would be most _____ (APPRECIATE) of your support.
3. Please do not _____ to contact me.
4. Should you _____ any further information, please let me know.
5. I trust that this proposal meets _____ your approval.
6. The event would _____ (DOUBT) benefit the whole school.
7. We have taken every _____ to ensure everyone’s safety.
8. I look forward to hearing from you at your earliest _____.
9. In _____ to your concern about cost, the families will provide the food.
10. Not _____ will the event celebrate diversity, but it will also involve families.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right word, or type it.

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1. We would like to ___ your permission to use the hall. [1 point]

a) beg **b)** request **c)** require **d)** demand

2. The proposal ___ several of the concerns raised last year. [1 point]

a) addresses **b)** speaks **c)** directs **d)** answers to

3. Every activity will be _____ (SUPERVISE) by members of staff. [2 points]

4. The event will be fully _____ (INCLUDE): every family is welcome. [2 points]

Like the exam: Grammar 1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right form, or type it.

1. If you need more details, please contact me. SHOULD → _____ more details, please contact me. [2 points]

2. We would really like you to attend. GRATEFUL → We would be _____ attend. [2 points]

3. Open cloze: We would appreciate it _____ you could reply by Friday. [2 points]

4. Open cloze: _____ to say, all costs will be covered by the families. [2 points]

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📚 Study guide: answer key

Look at them only when you have finished each activity.

Practise for Checkpoint 4

1. **regard** · with regard / reference to.
2. **appreciative** · appreciate → appreciative.
3. **hesitate** · do not hesitate to.
4. **require** · Should you require…
5. **with** · meet with someone's approval.
6. **undoubtedly** · doubt → undoubtedly.
7. **precaution** · take every precaution.
8. **convenience** · at your earliest convenience.
9. **response** · in response to.
10. **only** · Not only + inversion.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1. **request** · request permission.
2. **addresses** · address a concern.
3. **supervised** · supervise → supervised.
4. **inclusive** · include → inclusive.

Like the exam: Grammar

1. **should you need** · Should you + verb.
2. **grateful if you could** · We would be grateful if you could…
3. **if** · appreciate it if…
4. **needless** · Needless to say…

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Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Student council meeting

Laia: OK, everyone. We're meeting the head teacher on Monday, so we need a plan today.

Omar: Right. The event is going to be about festivals of light: Diwali, Hanukkah, Lunar New Year and Christmas.

Laia: Good. When is it?

Omar: It's on Friday the eleventh of December. School finishes at two, so the event starts at ten and finishes at one thirty.

Laia: Where's it going to take place?

Omar: In the school hall. There will be four stalls, one for each festival.

Laia: What about food?

Omar: I'll ask the families. I think a lot of parents will help.

Laia: Great. And music?

Omar: My cousin plays in a band. I'll call him tonight.

Laia: Perfect. Who's going to put up the decorations?

Omar: Class 4B is going to make paper lanterns in Art.

Laia: And the invitations?

Omar: We're sending them on Wednesday. We're going to invite families and the primary school.

Laia: OK. One problem: the hall is small. What if it rains and everyone is inside?

Omar: Don't worry. We'll use the gym too.

Laia: Good idea. I think it'll be the best day of the term!

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